



Butterflies

The flower heads of buddleia are so popular with butterflies that it is known as the butterfly bush.

Flexible stigmas collect pollen from the lorikeet's head.

Strong, grasping claws help the parrot hang onto the branch while drinking nectar.

Lesser long-nosed bat

The bat's flexible tongue helps it reach deep inside a flower.

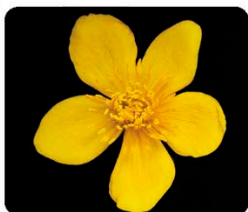
Rainbow lorikeet

These tubular saguaro cactus flowers cover the bat's nose in pollen as it reaches inside to drink nectar.



NECTAR GUIDES

Unlike humans, bees can see ultraviolet (UV) light. Many flowers, such as this marsh marigold, may appear plain to us, but under UV light, we can see how the petals have dark patterns that guide insects to their nectar and pollen.



Under normal light



Under UV light

More than **500 species** of plants are **pollinated by bats**.

as **ladybugs**, also pollinate pale-colored flowers but choose fruity-smelling blooms. These flowers mimic the scent of ripe fruit to trick beetles into visiting them for food. Of the larger pollinators, birds are attracted to bright, day-flowering blossoms. **Hummingbirds** favor reddish flowers,

but these tend not to be scented, since birds do not have a sense of smell. The petals of bird-pollinated flowers are usually bent back to allow the animals easy access. **Bats** pollinate some night-flowering plants and are attracted to large, pale flowers with a musty smell.